

wooden weapons were used. Their purpose was to get the gladiators in the fighting spirit and to excite the crowd.

There were at least 16 (maybe as many as 20) different types of gladiator. A fighter was trained as one particular type, ranging from a lightly armed *secutor* ("chaser") or *retiarius* ("net-fighter") to a more heavily armed *thraex* ("Thracian") and *murmillo* (named after the fish emblem on his helmet). Each

type was instantly recognizable by the crowd, and spectators knew how each type of gladiator would fight.

At a sign from the holder of the games, the band began to play. Musicians sounded trumpets, flutes, horns, and wheezy water organs, and amid this noise, the fighting began.

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MAXIMUS (RIGHT), THE HERO OF THE SMASH-HIT FILM *GLADIATOR*, FIGHTS FOR HIS LIFE IN THE ARENA.

